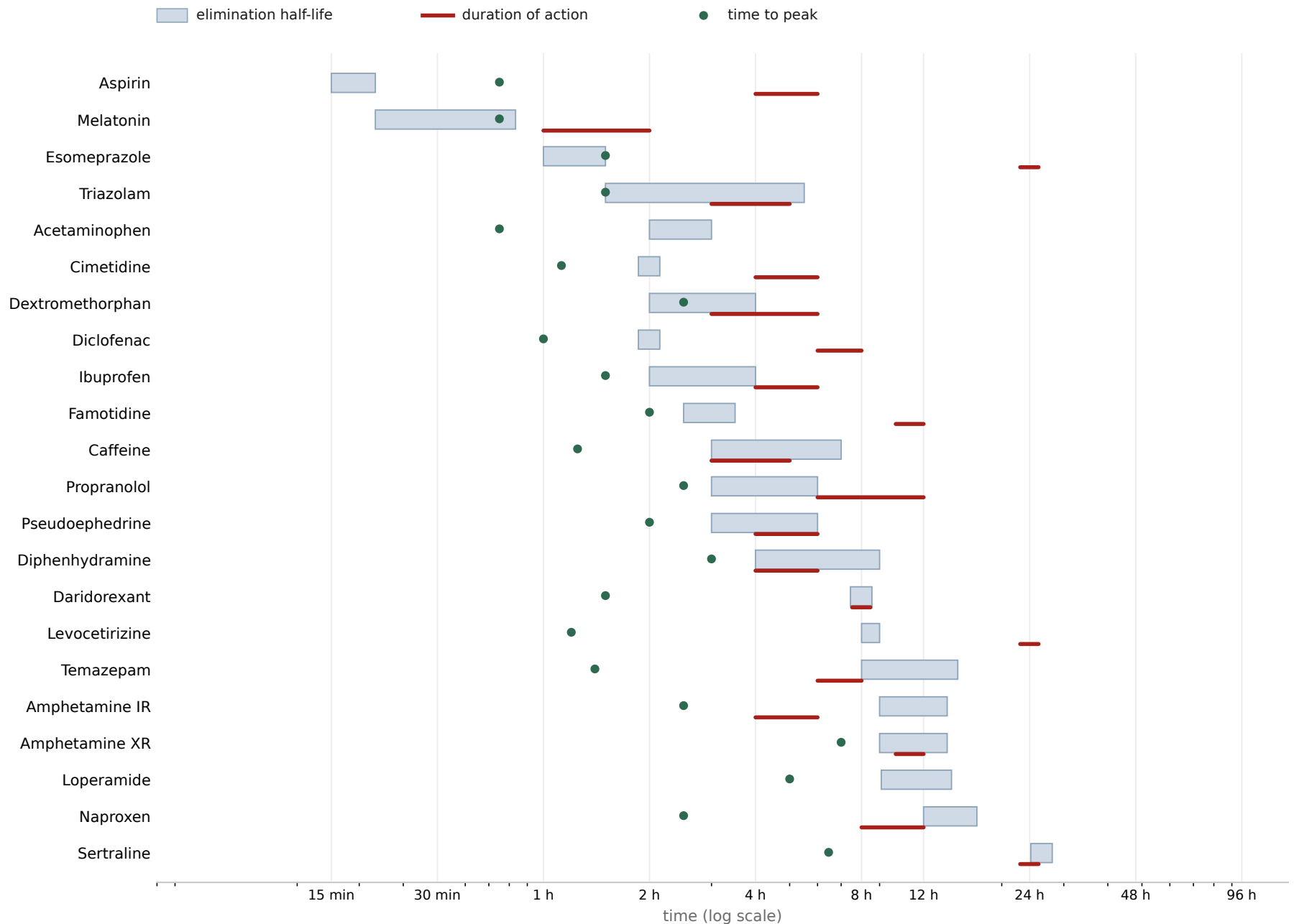


Pharmacokinetics at a glance

Elimination half-life (bar) against duration of clinical effect (line) and time to peak (dot). Log scale.
Where the two disagree, the mechanism rather than the kinetics is setting the dosing interval.



Aspirin is the clearest case where half-life misleads: 15-20 minutes for intact drug, 4-6 hours of analgesia carried by salicylate, and 7-10 days of antiplatelet effect set by platelet turnover. Esomeprazole is the same story — a 1 h half-life, 24 h of acid suppression, because it binds the pump covalently. Neither is derivable from the kinetics.